

# Honey Cough Syrup

The recipe, the dose, and the dogs who should never have it.

## The Recipe

Stir the honey into warm (never hot) water until fully dissolved, then add the lemon. Offer it slowly by spoon, or mix into a little soft food. Never force it into the mouth, that can cause them to inhale it.

| Your Dog's Weight | Raw Honey      | Lemon Juice | How Often           |
|-------------------|----------------|-------------|---------------------|
| Under 20 lbs      | 1/4 to 1/2 tsp | A few drops | Up to 2x a day      |
| 20 to 50 lbs      | 1/2 to 1 tsp   | 1/4 tsp     | Up to 2 to 3x a day |
| 50 lbs and up     | Up to 1 tbsp   | 1/2 tsp     | Up to 2 to 3x a day |

## Use Raw Honey

- Raw, unfiltered honey works best (buckwheat or other dark honey is strongest)
- Plain honey only, NEVER honey or any product containing xylitol, which is deadly to dogs
- Warm water, not hot, so you do not destroy the beneficial compounds

**NEVER GIVE HONEY TO:** puppies under 12 months (botulism risk), diabetic dogs, overweight dogs, or dogs with weak immune systems (on chemo, with Cushing's). For these dogs, honey can do real harm.

**HONEY ONLY SOOTHES, IT DOES NOT CURE.** A cough can be a sign of something serious. See the red-flag list below and call your vet if your dog shows any of them, or if the cough lasts more than a few days.

## Call Your Vet Right Away If You See:

- Any trouble breathing, or fast or heavy breathing
- Blue, gray, or pale gums

- Coughing up blood, or non-stop coughing
- Collapse, extreme weakness, or refusing to eat or drink
- A soft, wet cough at night plus tiredness (possible heart issue)
- A cough lasting more than 1 to 2 weeks or getting worse